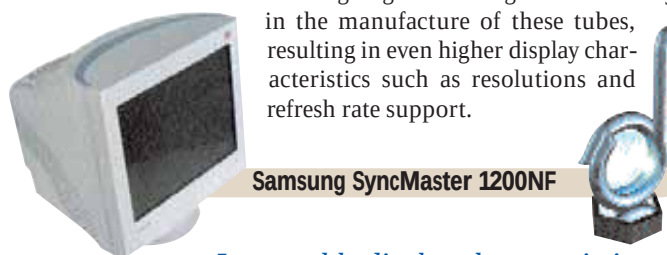


MONITORS (21-INCH)

The big daddy of monitors, these display titans have represented the final frontier for professional graphics and image editing applications in CRT display systems. In terms of their sheer size and support for high resolutions, they are ideally suited for applications where you need to get a whole lot of information on the screen without having to forfeit the effective size of the displayed content. Since these displays are primarily used by professionals, they usually support a plethora of features that cater to these segments such as multiple inputs of different standards and formats, integrated connectivity, etc.

The challenge that has always been before 21-inch monitors is that of the fabrication of flat tubes. While there have been a handful of players that have succeeded in creating flat 21-inch monitors, this is not yet a standard. Future advancements in this arena are going to involve greater efficiency in the manufacture of these tubes, resulting in even higher display characteristics such as resolutions and refresh rate support.



Samsung SyncMaster 1200NF

Impeccable display characteristics coupled with a plethora of features

Based on an Aperture Grille tube, this monitor is replete with a variety of features and boasts impeccable image characteristics. Featuring an integrated USB and ports, and BNC connectors, it is ideally suited for professional applications that need this kind of connectivity and features. Additionally, this monitor features a flat tube—a distinction that only a handful of other manufacturers have been able to boast of.

- + Flat tube, high resolution and refresh rate support
 - + USB connectors and BNC video inputs
- Price:** Rs 55,000
Contact: Samsung Electronics India

Phone: 011-6322517
Fax: 011- 6322607
E-mail: marketing@samsungindia.com
Reviewed in: December 2001

Worthy Mentions

LG StudioWorks 221U

- + Very good refresh rate and resolution support
 - + Integrated USB ports
- Price:** Rs 49,500
Contact: LG Electronics India Ltd
Phone: 011-6910123
Fax: 011-6936847
E-mail: sanjaym@lginida.com
Reviewed in: September 2001

Viewsonic G810

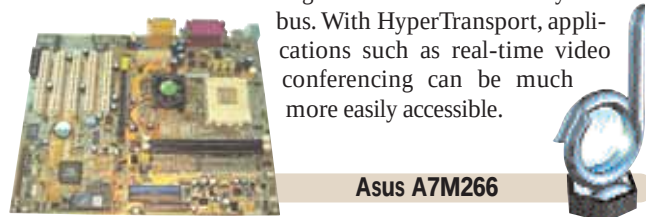
- + High resolutions at very high refresh rates
 - + Low dot pitch
- Price:** Rs 46,500
Contact: Roop Technologies Pvt Ltd
Phone: 022-663 1921 to 24
Fax: 022-6103919
E-mail: roop@vsnl.com
Reviewed in: September 2001

PREVIOUS WINNERS 2000: Sony CPD-G500 1999: NA 1998: NA

MOTHERBOARDS (AMD)

It's been a long and hard history for AMD, having to follow in the footsteps of Intel. Today, a totally different picture is painted now that their Athlon and Duron chips knock the socks off an equivalently clocked Pentium 4 and Celeron, respectively. Motherboards made under the Socket A platform have been given a boost thanks to the native 133 MHz FSB support of newer AMD chips. Add to that support for DDR memory and you've got yourself one powerhouse of a motherboard!

AMD's newest 64-bit processor, code-named Hammer, will have an integrated memory controller which will allow itself to bypass the chipset in order to access system memory. This allows memory access to scale with CPU speeds instead of being stuck with slowly advancing speeds of the FSB. Along with Hammer comes AMD brainchild HyperTransport, capable of supporting a much higher bandwidth than today's PCI bus. With HyperTransport, applications such as real-time video conferencing can be much more easily accessible.



Asus A7M266

With DDR support, this AMD motherboard is your best bet for bandwidth-heavy applications such as image editing and performance gaming

One of the best solutions available for the AMD Athlon and Duron processor based on the AMD761 chipset, ASUS A7M266 board is built to complement the power of the CPU. This was otherwise an issue since the clock speeds were increasing with every passing week but the bottlenecks were the chipsets controlling the memory subsystems onboard. This board delivers just the solution to the power users who are going in for the fastest Athlon 1.4 or the Duron with DDR RAM support.

- + Four PCI slots
 - + DDR RAM upgradeable to 2 GB
- Price:** Rs 13,000
Contact: Rashi Peripherals
- Phone:** 022-8260256-59
Fax: 022-8221012
E-mail: ho@rptechindia.com
Reviewed in: October 2001

Worthy Mentions

ASUS A7 Pro

- + Very good memory bandwidth scores
 - + Very stable even after over-clocking
- Price:** Not available
Contact: Rashi Peripherals
Phone: 022-8260256-59
Fax: 022-8221012
E-mail: ho@rptechindia.com
Reviewed in: March 2001

Soltek SL75KV2

- + Stable with good performance scores
 - + Feature-rich content (includes Norton Ghost 2000, Norton AntiVirus 2000 and WinFax)
- Price:** Not available
Contact: Rank Data Products
Phone: 022-3873168
Fax: 022-3866308
E-mail: rankdata@vsnl.com
Reviewed in: March 2001

PREVIOUS WINNERS 2000: ASUS A7M 1999: NA 1998: NA